

Distortion Correction

Distortion in photographs could be Barrel distortion—a lens effect that leaves photos with a spherical distortion at the centre, or it could be Pincushion distortion, which results in images that are pinched in the centre.

An easy solution to correct this would be to use the Panorama Tools plug-in for Photoshop that can be downloaded from <http://home.no.net/dmaurer/~dersch/Index.htm>. Open the ZIP file, and extract the pano12.dll file in the folder where Photoshop is installed.

Now, extract all the files inside the 'Photoshop Plugin' in the ZIP file to the Photoshop Plug-Ins or Filters directory. Restart Photoshop and open the photo in need of correction. First, go to **Filter > Panorama Tools > Correct** to bring up the 'Correct Options' dialog box. Select Radial Shift, and click on the option next to it to bring up the 'Set Polynomial Coefficients for Radial Correction' dialog box. Set 'a' and 'c' to zero for all colours, and choose a value for 'b' and 'd' such that their values add up to one. The values for 'b' should be negative to correct barrel distortion, and positive to rectify pincushion distortions. Start with 0.015 for 'b' and 0.085 for 'd' to correct pincushion, and -0.015 and +1.015 for barrel distortion. Increase or decrease the values gradually until the images are corrected properly.

Refer to the Readme.html file inside the ZIP file for further details.

